

Ramakrishna Sayee Meka

TECH LEAD / SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER

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Senior Software Engineer and Tech Lead with 8 years building Tier-1 distributed systems and modern frontends. Led the unification of Nordstrom's fragmented inventory systems into OVI, a single source of truth for every SKU state change, handling 5M+ events daily at 99.99% availability. Built event driven platforms on Apache Kafka and micro-frontends serving 15,000+ dealerships, and is now going deep on AI engineering, building LLM powered tools.

— SKILLS

Languages

Java, Python, JavaScript, C#, SQL, Kotlin, Groovy

Backend & APIs

Spring Boot, Apache Kafka, Node.js, REST, gRPC, Hibernate/JPA, Microservices, JUnit

Frontend

React, Redux, Angular, RxJS, Micro-Frontends, HTML/CSS

Cloud & DevOps

AWS, Kubernetes, OpenShift, Docker, Helm, Terraform, Vault, Kong API Gateway, GitHub Actions, GitLab CI

Data & AI

PostgreSQL, Oracle, MySQL, Redis, DynamoDB, MongoDB, Elasticsearch, Spark, Flink, Apache Airflow, OpenAI GPT, LLMs

Practices

System Design, Distributed Systems, Event-Driven Architecture, Agile/Scrum, CI/CD, Observability

— EDUCATION

M.S. Computer Science

Syracuse University · GPA 3.50 · 2018

B.S. Computer Science

JNTU Hyderabad (VNR VJIET), India · GPA 3.72 · 2015

— RECOGNITION

Best in Show — Cox internal hackathon (Hot Deals widget, later productionized).

— EXPERIENCE

Senior Software Engineer, Tech Lead · Nordstrom

Aug 2022 – Apr 2026

Seattle, WA

- Led the technical unification of multiple inventory systems (WIT, EIS, Link marketplace, store ledger, dropship) into the **OVI platform**, a single source of truth across **10 warehouses, 950+ stores, and 1000+ marketplace vendors** for 10+ downstream teams.
- Routed and secured all OVI API traffic through **Kong API Gateway**, enforcing rate limiting, throttling, and per-consumer authentication, with OAuth 2.0, JWT, and Okta SSO for service-to-service auth.
- Built **20+ Apache Airflow jobs** (Python DAGs with custom operators, retries, and lineage tracking) orchestrating the audit flows, initial loads, and data pipelines for the OVI platform.
- Built the Cache Comparison Service validating the EIS-to-OVI migration against a **200M+ record Redis cache at a 99.5%+ match rate**, feature-flagging the cutover across **200+ locations** with instant fallback.
- Optimized streaming components and APIs for a **100-300x query improvement** (5–15s to 40ms) at 95K TPM, with 30+ custom metrics, OpenTelemetry tracing, and New Relic.
- Designed Kafka event schemas and Avro contracts for **40+ event types**; deployed Java/Spring Boot services to Kubernetes/OpenShift with Docker and Helm, hardened with circuit breakers, idempotency, and DLQ handling.
- Built a **Text-to-SQL chatbot** on OpenAI GPT for self-serve inventory queries across MySQL, PostgreSQL, and MariaDB, cutting on-call support and ad-hoc data requests.
- Designed a Transfer Reconciliation system with variance detection targeting **~\$65M** annual retail loss, and a dynamic matrix CI/CD pattern adopted as the GitLab to GitHub migration template.

Software Engineer II · Nordstrom

Dec 2020 – Jul 2022

Seattle, WA

- Designed the **WIT real time streaming platform** on Apache Kafka, the ledger of record for stock on hand; re-architected as WIT 2.0 for banner-level tracking within shared warehouses at **1M+ daily transactions**.
- Pioneered a multi-schema architecture for a distributed transaction system at **50K TPM** with partition management for controlled facility onboarding.
- Built a serverless observability platform on AWS Lambda streaming to Splunk and New Relic, adopted as the standard across engineering teams.

Software Engineer I · Nordstrom

Jan 2020 – Nov 2020

Seattle, WA

- Built the system of reference for warehouse transactions and SKU state changes; the audit service contributed to a **\$10M+ annual reduction** in inventory shrinkage.
- Led the observability migration from Datadog to New Relic across 8 services, establishing standardized dashboards and alerting.

Software Engineer · Cox Automotive

Jul 2018 – Dec 2019

Dallas, TX

- Built a multi-tenant **micro-frontend** (React, Redux, Angular, Node.js) serving **15,000+ dealerships** from a single codebase with dealer level customization and canary rollouts.
- Integrated Angular and React front ends with Java/Spring Boot REST APIs and polyglot C#, .NET, and Node.js services driving incentive evaluation and vehicle promotion surfacing.
- Cut widget re-render time by 50% with React portals; won **Best in Show** at the hackathon for the Hot Deals widget, later productionized.